

BUILDING A SERVER FROM SCRATCH

Virtualising the Server

Set up VirtualBox on the main server and deploy each service on a separate virtual machine.

I know, I know... you were expecting how to configure a Web server this time. However, the set-up that I described has more than a few glitches. First of all, putting in all the software in one environment can lead to data getting polluted. Second, since I was going to do virtualisation anyway, why just keep it as a role? Why not put it to use? So, anyway...

Pre-summary

- Role: Virtualisation
- Priority: Required
- Dependencies: Basic server
- Features: A VirtualBox server environment with one virtual machine (VM) dedicated to each role. Each VM will be running CentOS 5, a free-of-cost

version of Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) 5 built with the same sources.

- Extensible: Yes
- Ease of set-up: Very easy but needs a lot of patience.
- Software Set: Sun xVM VirtualBox, CentOS 5.2
- Set-up time: 3 hours

A little explaining

Let me explain what we are going to do.

Virtualisation is all about packing more into one. Basically, the kind of virtualisation we are going to do here allows us to install more than one operating system on one computer and then run them simultaneously. For that, we need a hypervisor—a software that manages this virtualisation. Our